

the product to colour the picture. The life paintings with high resemblance were the top-quality, and the drawings closely imitating on ancient ones were the best, differing in varied styles and pursuits. The strict and careful division in profession made it possible for the craftsman of single work to keep on improving his skill, resulting in a large quantity of products with unified and standard modelling and pattern. Everything was carried out in good order without confusion.

RENOVATION OF GLAZE-APPLICATION Glazing inside both the rounding ware and the engraving ware was adopted by the way of shaking glaze (*dangyou*). Glazing outside of the small rounding ware was applied by the way of dipping glaze (*zhanyou*) in the *Gang*, while that of the large rounding or engraving ware was applied by the way of blowing glaze (*chuiyou*): using a tiny bamboo slip above 20 cm with one of its ends covered by fine gauze, to dip it with glaze slip and blow it over the body. This new method has strong points in directionality and flexibility and could apply glazes evenly to all kinds of complicate-formed utensils with the corresponding thickness of glaze in line with the chemical and physical nature of different glazes, which made the finished porcelains smoother and brighter, eliminating the defects such as ill-distribution, unsmoothness and fragility of glaze surface when using the ways of dipping glaze and of brushing glaze (*taiyou*).

STABILITY IN FIRING Porcelains was an "art of firing." The potters in Jingdezhen made full use of local natural resources and worked out the "Kiln Stabilizer (*zhenyao*)" in shape of urn so as to cater for the burning environment for porcelain body. Till the Qing Dynasty, the craftsmen had gained excellent experience about the firing temperature of the kiln. When charging kiln (*manyao*), they piled up the saggars and arranged in a certain style vertically and horizontally with the middle channels left open for fire passing through. The positions of bodies with different hard or soft glaze slip were arranged according to the difference in temperature inside the kiln. The fire was violent in the front, less tense in the middle and gentle in the rear. The rough utensils were put in the first and the last three lines with the delicate ones put in the middle of the kilns. The Imperial Factory had a very strict requirement that utensils in the same firing should have the same colour, so the empty saggars were used in the front to baffle the fire. During Yongzheng Reign the production of large *Gang* not only was resumed but also surpassed the precedent dynasties in quality.

NEW TECHNOLOGIES OF COLOUR PAINTING During the Kangxi and Yongzheng reigns there invented the *Fencai* and

the enamel decorations, completing the real five-colours on overglaze. The paint pigment started being mixed with mastic gum, which had a strong stickiness and a high thickness, and could be used to sketch the contours of lines as delicate as hair, to play up the slight changes in brightness and darkness, deepness and shallowness, to express the brush-and-ink effects of traditional Chinese paintings in freehand, depicting, fine and delicate strokes and so on, which remarkably upgraded the artistic expression of the colour pattern on overglaze.

The characteristics of traditional products were inherited in the reigns of Kangxi, Yongzheng and Qianlong. The technique of decoration made a further breakthrough. The drawing methods of landscapes, flower-and-bird and figures were deeply influenced by traditional Chinese paintings, woodcuts, Spring Festival Pictures (*nianhua*) and other arts and crafts, and formed a unique artistic language and typical style and features of the times by combining the properties of porcelain materials.

KANGXI QINGHUA The hue or tone was verdant and beautiful, with lucid and lively and limpid drawings of points, lines and surface full of sense of rhythm. Using the theory of traditional Chinese painting that "China black ink should have five tones" for reference, the craftsmen divided *Qinghua* slip into five colour-ranks: "the densest (*tounong*), the denser (*zhengnong*), the dense (*ernong*), the lighter (*zhengdan*), the lightest (*yingdan*)," which made it much richer in single colour especially to express the structure and texture of mountains and rocks: dipping slightly the brush with pigment in clean water before drawing and the water distributed (*fenshui*) rapidly, the beginning of each stroke was mild and pointed and the ending of the stroke dense and mellow. The concave-convex shape of mountains and rocks was vividly revealed by the colour from mild to dense, from shallow to deep and from bright to dark, melting the lingering charm of the brush-and-ink in the tranquil and transparent artistic state. Using the ink-and-brush style to sketch the contours prevailed in the flower-and-bird paintings, which filled with mild colours outside the contours (*fenshui*) usually for the purpose to make stand out the nobleness, unsulliedness, simpleness and elegance of *yulan* flower and egret. The *Qinghua* rather stressed that the colour should be viewed distinct and contrasting between the white and black in the distance while the strokes and pigments even and images lifelike at the close sight.

The Kangxi underglaze red decoration was characterised by its stable hue, bright and beautiful, with exquisite patterns, and fine, robust and clear lines. It was in perfect harmony with the *Qinghua*,